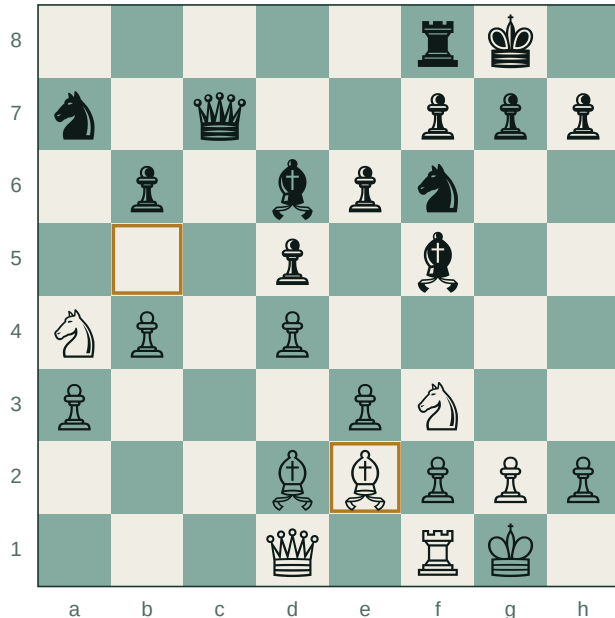


Interference tactics: Black, move 19

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Be2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...Bc2 20. Qa1 Bxa4

19...Bc2 The bishop moves from f5 to c2. From c2 it attacks queen on d1 and knight on a4. Recorded reply: **20.Qa1**.

20...Bxa4 The bishop captures the knight on a4.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.